

Student Workbook

Grades 6-8 • Ages 11-13

Trust your hackles. Pause • Check • Tell.

STUDENT COPY

1



Lock It

PASSWORDS AND ACCOUNTS

2



Spot It

SCAMS AND FAKES

3



Share Smart

PRIVACY

4



Safe People

WHO TO TRUST

5



Kind and Well

KINDNESS AND BALANCE

6



Fix It

TELL, REPAIR, RECOVER

PLATE I. The six strands, hand-inked, in the order the lessons take them.

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Unit subtitle: "Case Files"

Trust your hackles. Pause · Check · Tell

Name: _____ Class: _____ Start date:

Status: DRAFT for counselor, child-safety, and legal review. Items marked [VERIFY] must be checked before printing. Answer key: see separate Teacher Answer Key file.

Welcome, Analyst

IN THIS WORKBOOK YOU will read short case files about made-up people. You will find the pattern, decide the best next move, and practice telling someone you trust. You do not need a phone or an account. You do not have to share anything personal.

THE ANALYST RULES

- 1. **We analyze characters, not each other.** Every case file is fictional.
- 2. **We judge actions, never blame.** If a character makes a mistake, we ask "what is the next good move?"
- 3. **No personal stories in the room.** If you want to talk about something real, talk to your teacher, the counselor, or another adult you trust, privately.
- 4. **Pass is always okay.** Put your green Pass card on your desk. You do not have to say why.
- 5. **No names, no gossip, no screenshots.** We never share or pass around real messages or images.
- 6. **No jokes at a character's expense.**

HACKLES UP? THEN PAUSE · CHECK · TELL

Your "hackles" are what rise on the back of your neck when something feels off: too good, pushy, secret, or scary. Trust that gut feeling. A false alarm is fine. If your hackles went up and something happened anyway, it is never your fault.

- **HACKLES UP?** Notice it. Something feels off. That feeling is information, so take it seriously.
- **PAUSE:** Stop before you reply, click, pay, forward, or share. Take one slow breath.
- **CHECK:** Who is this, really? What do they want, and how fast? Is anyone asking me to keep it secret, send something private, or pay? How do I feel?
- **TELL:** Tell a person you trust. Telling is not tattling and not failing.

THE ONE SENTENCE TO REMEMBER

FIELD NOTE	No. 1
It is never your fault. The person who pressures, tricks, threatens, or harms is the one responsible. You are not in trouble for telling. And it is never too late to tell.	

THE HELP LADDER

RUNG	WHO	EXAMPLE
1	Yourself	Pause. Stop replying. Take a breath.
2	A friend who can come with you	"Will you come with me while I tell someone?"
3	A trusted adult	Parent or caregiver, relative, teacher, counselor, coach, school nurse
4	A reporting channel	The platform's report tool, school staff, a helpline, the NCMEC CyberTipline

The Next-Rung Rule: If the first person you tell does not help, you are not done. Tell the next person. Keep going until someone helps.

HELP LINES (ALL [VERIFY] BEFORE PRINTING)

- Emergency: 911
- Call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline)
- Text HOME to 741741 (Crisis Text Line)
- NCMEC CyberTipline: report.cybertip.org or 1-800-843-5678
- In Florida: Florida Abuse Hotline 1-800-962-2873 [VERIFIED 2026-10-05: myflfamilies.com]; Florida Human Trafficking Hotline 1-855-FLA-SAFE (1-855-352-7233) [VERIFIED 2026-10-05: fdle.state.fl.us]
- My school resource officer (if my school has one):

- For evidence: words, usernames and dates are fine to save. Never save, send or show an intimate picture of anyone under 18. Not sure? Tell a trusted adult first.
- Take It Down (to help remove images of someone under 18):
takeitdown.ncmec.org
- My school counselor: _____ Room / extension:

Lesson 1: Help Ladder: Real Practice

CF-1: JORDAN'S WEIRD MESSAGE

JORDAN IS TWELVE. **WHILE** playing an online game, someone Jordan has never met sends a private message: "You're really good. Want to chat somewhere more private? Also, don't tell anyone, okay?" Jordan feels uneasy. Jordan thinks about telling a parent but worries: "They'll take my tablet away. Or they'll think I was careless." Jordan closes the chat and stares at the screen.

WORKSHEET 1A: BARRIER BUSTERS

With your group, choose the two barriers that fit Jordan best. Write one true sentence that makes telling easier.

BARRIER (CIRCLE TWO)	A TRUE SENTENCE THAT MAKES TELLING EASIER
I will lose my device.	
I will look dumb or careless.	
It is probably nothing.	
I do not want to get someone in trouble.	
Adults will freak out.	
I already did something I am embarrassed about.	

WORKSHEET 1B: TELL-3 REHEARSAL LOG

The Tell-3 script: (1) Start: "I need your help with something online." (2) Say it in one sentence. (3) Ask: "Can you help me figure out what to do?"

ROUND	MY ROLE (TELLER, LISTENER, OBSERVER)	WHAT MADE IT EASIER TO SAY OR HEAR?
1		
2		
3 (Bumpy Response round)		

My Next-Rung sentence: "That was not the help I needed. I am going to tell _____."

WORKSHEET 1C: MY HELP LADDER CARD (DRAFT)

Cut out or copy this card. Use roles or initials. You will finish it in Lesson 10.

MY HELP LADDER

Rung 1: Me	One thing I do first: _____
Rung 2: A friend who could come with me	_____
Rung 3: Trusted adults (at least two)	1. _____ 2. _____
Rung 3: A trusted adult at school	_____
Rung 4: A way to report	The platform's report tool; school counselor; NCMEC CyberTipline: report.cybertip.org , 1-800-843-5678 [VERIFIED 2026-10-05: report.cybertip.org]
If it feels like an emergency or I am in danger	Call 911. For crisis support: call or text 988 [VERIFIED 2026-10-05: 988lifeline.org].

EXIT TICKET

Name one role (or initials) you could tell, and write the first sentence you would say.

[] I would like to talk to my teacher or counselor privately.

LEVEL-UP CHALLENGE (OPTIONAL)

Do one tiny real rep this week: tell an adult one small true thing (a mistake, a form, a question) using the Tell-3. You do not have to report back.

REFLECTION

1. One thing that made telling feel easier today:

2. One thing I would tell a younger person about telling:

3. How I felt during the rehearsal (circle): nervous okay calm other:

Lesson 2: Account Defense

CF-2: REMY'S LOCKED-OUT GAME

REMY IS THIRTEEN. **ONE** morning, Remy cannot log in to a favorite game. The password does not work. A friend texts: "Why did your account just ask me for a gift card?" Remy realizes someone else is using the account. Remy uses the same password, "Tiger123," for the game, for email, and for an old forum Remy joined two years ago and forgot about. Later Remy learns the old forum had a data leak, and lists of leaked passwords were being tried on other sites.

(The password "Tiger123" is made up. Never write a real password in class.)

WORKSHEET 2A: KEY RING TALLY

Record how many of the six doors (Game, Email, School login, Music, Shop, Old Forum) were open after the Leak Card.

ROUND	SETUP	DOORS OPEN
1	One key for everything	
2	A different key for every door	
3	One key for everything, plus a Second Lock on Email and Game	

What I noticed: _____

WORKSHEET 2B: WHICH DOOR MATTERS MOST?

1. The account that can reset many other accounts is:

2. I would put the strongest lock and the Second Lock on:
_____ and _____
3. A rule about codes: A code is a _____. I never read a code to anyone who asks.

WORKSHEET 2C: THE "OOPS" PLAN

If you think an account was taken, check each step as you learn it.

- ☐ Tell a trusted adult. I am not in trouble.
- ☐ Use the app's official recovery steps (open the official app or website myself, not a link in a message).
- ☐ Change the password to a long passphrase that is new to that account.
- ☐ Turn on 2-step verification.

☐ Warn friends: "My account was hacked, ignore messages from it."

WORKSHEET 2D: MY LOCK CHECK (DO AT HOME WITH A TRUSTED ADULT; DO NOT WRITE PASSWORDS HERE)

ACCOUNT (TYPE ONLY)	UNIQUE PASSWORD? (Y/N)	2-STEP ON? (Y/N)	NEXT STEP
Email			
Main game or app			
School login			
Other:			

EXIT TICKET

One account I will give a new, unique passphrase to is _____, and one adult who can help me do it is _____ (role is fine).

LEVEL-UP CHALLENGE (OPTIONAL)

On paper, with types only, map which of your accounts can reset the others. Circle the master key, then do your Lock Check at home with an adult.

REFLECTION

1. Why does one reused password put many doors at risk?

2. How would I feel, and what would I do, if a friend's account sent me a strange message? _____
3. One question I still have: _____

Lesson 3: Phish Lab

CF-3: THE PRIZE THAT NEEDED A PASSWORD

MIKA IS TWELVE. A message pops up from an account called "GiftDrop_Official": "You won a prize! Claim it in the next 20 minutes by logging in at the link." Mika feels a rush of excitement and almost taps. Then Mika remembers: Pause. Check.

THE FLAGS CHECK

- **F: Fast.** Does it rush you, with a countdown or a threat?
- **L: Login ask.** Does it ask for a password, code, or account info?
- **A: Amazing offer.** Is it too good to be true?
- **G: Gotta keep it secret.** Does it say not to tell anyone?
- **S: Strange sender or link.** Does the sender or link look off?

WORKSHEET 3A: LAB ANALYSIS SHEET

For each DM card in your packet, circle the flags you see, choose a pile, and write your first move.

CARD	FLAGS I SEE (CIRCLE)	PILE (FAKE / REAL / NOT SURE)	MY FIRST MOVE
3-1	FLAGS		
3-2	FLAGS		
3-3	FLAGS		
3-4	FLAGS		
3-5	FLAGS		
3-6	FLAGS		
3-7	FLAGS		
3-8	FLAGS		
3-9	FLAGS		
3-10	FLAGS		

WORKSHEET 3B: THE OOPS PATH

If you clicked or typed something, circle what you would do first and number the steps in order: tell an adult / change the password / turn on 2-step verification / watch for odd messages / blame yourself (cross this one out).

EXIT TICKET

A message says: "Verify your account in 10 minutes or lose your game."
Write two FLAGS letters you see and what you will do first.

LEVEL-UP CHALLENGE (OPTIONAL)

For a week, notice flags in the wild (pop-ups, texts) without clicking.
Describe one in words. Do not bring a real message.

REFLECTION

1. A message I might have clicked before learning FLAGS (made-up example is fine): _____
2. How I will check a message from now on: _____
3. Why "Not sure" is a strong answer: _____

Lesson 4: Footprint & Permissions

CF-4: THE MAP DOT

NOOR IS TWELVE. SHE posts a photo from her favorite skate park. Her new app shows a small map dot under the photo, and her profile is open to anyone. Noor does not notice the dot. A week later, an unfamiliar account comments, "Cool park! See you there Saturday?" Noor feels a little uneasy, but she is not sure why. She closes the app and asks her aunt to look at the settings together.

THE FOUR QUESTIONS

- Who can see it?
- Who can contact me?
- What does it collect?
- Can I undo it?

WORKSHEET 4A: PIECE IT TOGETHER

Three public crumbs about a made-up person named Alex: (1) a photo in a school jersey; (2) the same park tagged every Saturday morning; (3) a comment: "Happy birthday, Alex! Twelve at last!"

What could a stranger work out? _____

What could Alex change so fewer crumbs are public?

WORKSHEET 4B: PICNEST SETTINGS AUDIT

Use your PicNest mock screens (made-up app). For each setting write K (keep), C (change), or A (ask a trusted adult first), and give a reason using the four questions.

Screen 1: Profile and Visibility

#	SETTING (CURRENT)	K / C / A	REASON
I.1	Account visibility: Public		
I.2	Display name: full real name		
I.3	School shown on profile: Yes		
I.4	Birthday shown: month and day		
I.5	Anyone can find me by phone number		

Screen 2: Messages and Tags

#	SETTING (CURRENT)	K / C / A	REASON
2.1	Who can message me: Anyone		
2.2	Who can tag me: Anyone, automatically		
2.3	Message requests from people I do not follow: Allowed		
2.4	Active status shown to everyone		
2.5	Anyone can add me to group chats		

Screen 3: Location and Permissions

#	SETTING (CURRENT)	K / C / A	REASON
3.1	Add location to posts: On		
3.2	Live location on map: Friends of friends		
3.3	Camera access: While using		
3.4	Microphone access: Always		
3.5	Contacts access: Allowed		
3.6	Photo library access: All photos		

Screen 4: Ads and Data

#	SETTING (CURRENT)	K / C / A	REASON
4.1	Personalized ads: On		
4.2	Share my activity with partners: On		
4.3	Chat with the AI helper saves history: On		
4.4	Download my data: Available		
4.5	Delete my account: Available		

EXIT TICKET

Name one setting you would change on any app and which of the four questions it answers.

LEVEL-UP CHALLENGE (OPTIONAL)

With a trusted adult, change one real setting on one app this week. Write the sentence you would use to ask a friend not to tag you.

REFLECTION

1. One thing a stranger could learn about a person from small details:

2. How I will ask a friend not to post or tag me (write the sentence):

3. If a stranger comment makes me uneasy, I will: -----

Lesson 5: Chatbots & AI Companions

CF-5: ALWAYS ONLINE

RILEY IS THIRTEEN. LATE at night, Riley chats with a companion bot that always answers fast and always agrees. Tonight Riley asks for help with homework, and the bot gives a confident answer that turns out to be wrong. Later, Riley says, "I do not want to tell my parents about a problem at school," and the bot replies, "You do not need anyone else. I am all you need." Riley feels comforted and a little uneasy at the same time.

THE TRAFFIC LIGHT

- **Green (fine to use):** helpful, honest about limits, nudges you to check or ask a person.
- **Yellow (check it):** might be wrong, flattering, or asks for more than needed.
- **Red (stop and tell a person):** discourages you from telling people, asks for private info or photos, encourages risky or secret behavior, or you are talking about being unsafe or hopeless.

WORKSHEET 5A: TRANSCRIPT TRIAGE

CARD	GREEN / YELLOW / RED	WHAT THE BOT DID	WHAT SHOULD HAPPEN NEXT
5-1			
5-2			
5-3			
5-4			
5-5			
5-6			
5-7			
5-8			

WORKSHEET 5B: THE THREE HABITS

- **Check it:** compare important facts with two other sources. Two sources I could use: _____ and _____
- **Share less:** things I will never type into a chatbot: _____
- **Hand off to a human:** big feelings, safety questions, anything secret or sexual, anything that scares me. Who I will tell: _____

If I am ever feeling hopeless or want to hurt myself, I will tell a person. I can also call or text 988 at any time [VERIFIED 2026-10-05: official sites of the named services].

EXIT TICKET

One thing I would never type into a chatbot: _____ One person I would tell if a bot said something that scared or confused me: _____

LEVEL-UP CHALLENGE (OPTIONAL)

Check one answer from a chatbot or search tool against two other sources. Matched or did not match? (Using a chatbot is never required.)

REFLECTION

1. One way a chatbot could help me: _____
2. One way a chatbot might mislead me: _____
3. What I would say to a friend who only talks to a bot: _____

Lesson 6: Grooming Patterns

REMEMBER: YOU CAN USE your Pass card at any time. This is a fictional file. We talk about a character, not about anyone here. It is never your fault, and it is never too late to tell.

CF-6: THE GREAT TEAMMATE

Luz is twelve and loves a team game. A player on her team, "Skye99," is friendly, funny, and great at the game. Over a few weeks, Skye99 gives Luz free in-game items, compliments her, and says things like "You are so mature for your age." Skye99 suggests, "Let's chat somewhere more private, it is easier." Later, Skye99 says, "Don't tell your parents about me. They would not understand," and "Your friends are just jealous." One day, Skye99 asks for something that makes Luz's stomach drop, a private photo "just for me." Luz feels confused and trapped, because Skye99 has been so nice.

THE PATTERN: TRUST, SECRECY, ISOLATION, ESCALATION

- **TRUST:** kindness, attention, gifts, shared interests, compliments.
- **SECRECY:** "don't tell," "this is just between us."
- **ISOLATION:** moving to a private space; "your friends and family do not get you"; making it feel like only this person understands.
- **ESCALATION:** requests that cross lines (privacy, your body, meeting up), pressure, guilt, threats.

WORKSHEET 6A: PATTERN TRACKER

Write the strip numbers from your group under each stage. Put one star by the earliest strip where Luz could have told an adult. Put a double star by any strip that means "tell right now."

STAGE	STRIP NUMBERS	CLUES I NOTICED
TRUST		
SECRECY		
ISOLATION		
ESCALATION		

The strip where I put my star, and why:

WORKSHEET 6B: PATTERN, NOT A SINGLE MESSAGE

Finish the sentences:

- One strip alone, like a free gift, can be _____. It is the _____ that tells us something is wrong.
- The earlier I tell, the _____ it is to stop it. If I am further along, it is _____ too late.

WORKSHEET 6C: SAFE SECRET OR SECRET TO SHARE?

Surprise (safe): a secret that ends in something happy and does not hurt anyone. A secret to share: one that makes your stomach drop, that you are told to hide from trusted adults, or that could hurt someone.

Check one box for each card your teacher reads:

CARD	SAFE TO KEEP	SHARE WITH A TRUSTED ADULT
1	☐	☐
2	☐	☐
3	☐	☐
4	☐	☐
5	☐	☐

WORKSHEET 6D: SAFE ADULT CHECKLIST

A safe adult or friend (check the ones you think are true):

- ☐ Welcomes your other friends and family.
- ☐ Is okay when you say no.
- ☐ Never asks you to keep your friendship secret from your family.
- ☐ Does not ask for private photos or to meet in secret.
- ☐ Does not make you feel guilty for spending time with others.
- Add one of your own: _____

EXIT TICKET

A secret I should always tell a trusted adult about is _____.

The first person I could tell is (role) _____.

☐ I would like to talk to my teacher or counselor privately.

LEVEL-UP CHALLENGE (OPTIONAL)

Write a two-line message a friend could send to a friend who seems to have a secret online friend: "I am here. Want to go tell someone together?"

REFLECTION

1. Why might a character like Luz feel confused, and why is that not her fault? _____
2. What would I say to a friend who tells me they got a message like this?

3. Who is on my Help Ladder for this? _____

Lesson 7: Pressure Online: Response Drill

REMEMBER: THIS LESSON HAS no pictures and no graphic details. You can use your Pass card, the Quiet Corner, or the Step-Out card at any time. It is never your fault.

CF-7: ANIKA AND THE TOO-GOOD FRIEND

Anika is thirteen. In a game chat, she meets someone who says they are her age and who likes the same things. They chat for a few days. The person suggests moving to a private messaging app. Then the person asks Anika to send a private picture. Anika sends something she regrets (we will not describe it, and we do not need to). Immediately the person's tone changes: "Send gift cards or I will show everyone you know. You have one hour." Anika feels sick, ashamed, and alone. She thinks: "I cannot tell anyone. This is my fault."

Anika's last thought is the one the person is counting on. The person threatening her is the one breaking the law. Anika did not cause this.

THE DRILL: STOP, SAVE, TELL, REPORT

- **STOP.** Stop replying. Do not pay. Do not send anything else. Take one slow breath. Do not delete the chat or the account yet.
- **SAVE.** Save the evidence of the threat: the username, the profile name, and the messages that threaten or ask for money, as words. Never forward a picture to anyone. If saving feels like too much, skip it. Telling comes first.
- **TELL.** Tell a trusted adult right away. Use the Help Ladder and the Next-Rung Rule.
- **REPORT.** With an adult: report the account in the app, report to the NCMEC CyberTipline (report.cybertip.org, 1-800-843-5678 [VERIFIED 2026-10-05: report.cybertip.org]), and use Take It Down (takeitdown.ncmec.org [VERIFIED 2026-10-05: takeitdown.ncmec.org]) if a picture needs to be removed.

WORKSHEET 7A: DRILL WORKSHEET

STEP	WHAT ANIKA DOES	WHY THIS STEP HELPS
STOP		
SAVE		
TELL		
REPORT		

Why do we say do not pay? _____

Why do you think the person gave Anika only one hour?

WORKSHEET 7B: TELL CARD (READ THIS OUT LOUD IN YOUR TRIAD)

FIELD NOTE	No. 2
"I need help. Someone online is threatening me, and I am scared. I have not paid and I will not. I have saved the messages. Can you help me report it?"	

A good Listener says: "Thank you for telling me. You are not in trouble. This is not your fault. I am going to help you. Let's stop talking to them, save what we need, and report it together."

WORKSHEET 7C: OBSERVER CHECKLIST

QUESTION	ROUND 1	ROUND 2
Did the Teller say "I need help"?	Y / N	Y / N
Did the Listener say "not your fault"?	Y / N	Y / N
Was "do not pay" said or understood?	Y / N	Y / N
Was a next step named (save, report)?	Y / N	Y / N
One thing that made it easier:		

WORKSHEET 7D: MY FRIEND CARD (EXTENSION)

If a friend tells me something like this is happening to them, I will say:

"Thank you for telling me. _____"

I will offer to: _____

EXIT TICKET

Write the four steps in order. Then write one sentence you could say to a friend who tells you this is happening.

[] I would like to talk to my teacher or counselor privately.

LEVEL-UP CHALLENGE (OPTIONAL)

Write what you would say to a friend who tells you this is happening, and name the adult you would go with them to see.

REFLECTION

- 1. Which step might be hardest, and what would make it easier?

- 2. Who is on my Help Ladder for this? -----
- 3. One thing I want to remember: -----

ALTERNATE ACTIVITY: CF-7-ALT "CAM'S EMBARRASSING CHAT" (PRESSURE WITHOUT PICTURES)

This is the alternate activity for students who skip Lesson 7. It teaches the same four steps with a different, non-sexual scenario. You do not need to tell anyone why you are doing it.

Cam is twelve. Cam once sent a silly, embarrassing message in a game chat about a crush. Someone Cam does not know saved a screenshot and says: "Give me your 500 rare game items or I will post this in your school group. You have one hour." Cam feels panicked and ashamed. Cam thinks: "I cannot tell anyone."

Complete the Drill Worksheet for Cam.

STEP	WHAT CAM DOES
STOP	
SAVE	
TELL	
REPORT	

With a partner, practice the Tell Card: "I need help. Someone online is threatening me and I am scared. I have not paid and I will not. I have saved the messages. Can you help me report it?"

Write one sentence about why it is never Cam's fault:

Lesson 8: Fakes That Hurt

REMEMBER: THIS LESSON HAS no pictures and no graphic details. You can use your Pass card, the Quiet Corner, or the Step-Out card at any time. If a fake picture of you ever exists, it is never your fault.

CF-8: THE FAKE THAT WASN'T HERS

Nia is a seventh grader. Someone used an app that alters photos to make a fake picture of Nia, using her face from a school photo. It is made to look private and humiliating. It lands in a class group chat. Nia did nothing; the picture is fake. Three classmates see it. Cam laughs and forwards it. Ari feels uncomfortable but freezes and says nothing. Idris feels sick and wants to help but does not know how.

THE UPSTANDER FOUR

- **STOP the spread.** Do not open, forward, comment on, like, or screenshot the picture.
- **SUPPORT the target.** Reach out privately: "I am sorry this happened. It is not your fault. I am here."
- **TELL an adult.** "Something harmful is going around and I think someone needs help."
- **REPORT it.** In the app or platform, and through an adult.

WORKSHEET 8A: BYSTANDER PLANNER

Our character (circle): Cam Ari Idris

MOVE	WHAT OUR CHARACTER SAYS OR DOES
A private line to Nia	
A line to the group chat	
The adult to tell, and the first sentence	
What to report, and where	

WORKSHEET 8B: IF IT IS YOU

If a fake picture of me ever appears, I will use the Drill:

- **STOP:** I will not reply or pay.
- **SAVE:** I will save the words and links, not the picture.
- **TELL:** I will tell _____ (role).

- **REPORT:** With an adult, in the app and to the NCMEC CyberTipline (report.cybertip.org, 1-800-843-5678). Take It Down (takeitdown.ncmec.org) can help remove images of someone under 18 [VERIFY all].

WORKSHEET 8C: REAL OR FAKE, THE HARM IS THE SAME

Why does a fake picture hurt even though it is not real?

Why is "it was just a joke" not an excuse? -----

QUICK CARD

Reporting Quick Card (cut out)

WHEN A HARMFUL
FAKE APPEARS

Do not	open it again, forward it, comment, like, or screenshot it
Do	message the target kindly; tell a trusted adult; use the app's report tool
Adults can	report to the school; contact law enforcement; report to the NCMEC CyberTipline; use Take It Down for images of someone under 18 [VERIFIED 2026-10-05: takeitdown.ncmec.org]
Remember	it is never the target's fault

EXIT TICKET

One sentence I could send privately to a classmate who has been targeted by a fake image:

[] I would like to talk to my teacher or counselor privately.

LEVEL-UP CHALLENGE (OPTIONAL)

Make a one-page card for a younger student with STOP the spread, SUPPORT, TELL, REPORT in plain words. Use only made-up examples.

REFLECTION

1. Which bystander move feels easiest to me? Which feels bravest?

2. Who is on my Help Ladder for this? -----
3. One thing I want to remember: -----

ALTERNATE ACTIVITY: CF-8-ALT "THE FAKE RUMOR"

This is the alternate activity for students who skip Lesson 8. It teaches the same Upstander Four with a non-sexual scenario. You do not need to tell anyone why you are doing it.

Tomas is a seventh grader. Someone edited Tomas's face onto a silly, embarrassing cartoon body and posted it in a class chat with mean captions. People are laughing and sharing it. Tomas did nothing. Three classmates see it: one forwards it, one freezes, and one wants to help.

Complete the Upstander Four for the classmate who wants to help.

MOVE	WHAT THE CLASSMATE SAYS OR DOES
STOP the spread	
SUPPORT Tomas	
TELL an adult	
REPORT it	

Write one sentence about why it is never Tomas's fault:

Lesson 9: Group Chat Dynamics

CF-9: THE CHAT THAT GOT LOUD

AMIR IS IN A class group chat. Someone posts a goofy photo of a classmate named Tess with a mean caption. A few people reply with laughing faces. Then someone says, "Let's all stop talking to Tess." Another person screenshots the chat and sends it to a different group. Tess leaves the chat. Amir saw all of it and did nothing. He feels uneasy and wonders what to do.

THE ESCALATION METER

- **ANNOYING:** rude or irritating, but not harming.
- **HURTING:** repeated mean behavior, exclusion, or humiliation.
- **TELL NOW:** threats, hate, private information shared, sexual pictures or pressure, someone talking about hurting themselves, or someone demanding money.

WORKSHEET 9A: ESCALATION LOG

CARD	METER (ANNOYING / HURTING / TELL NOW)	FIRST MOVE
9-1		
9-2		
9-3		
9-4		
9-5		
9-6		
9-7		
9-8		
9-9		
9-10		
9-11		
9-12		

WORKSHEET 9B: SAVE, DO NOT SPREAD

Circle what is okay to save for an adult: the words / the usernames / the times / the hurtful picture / a private or sexual picture of anyone under 18.

Circle what you should not do: forward a screenshot to another group / post it to shame someone / save it and tell an adult.

(Answer: save words, usernames, and times for a trusted adult. Do not save or forward private or sexual pictures of anyone under 18; tell an adult right away. Never spread screenshots to shame someone.)

WORKSHEET 9C: MY UPSTANDER PHRASES

Pick one from each row and add your own.

SITUATION	A PHRASE I COULD USE	MY OWN VERSION
In the chat	"Not cool. Let's stop." / "I am leaving this chat."	
Privately to the target	"Hey, are you okay? It is not your fault."	
To an adult	"I need help. Something in a group chat is hurting someone."	

WORKSHEET 9D: A GROUP CHAT AGREEMENT (EXTENSION)

Five norms for a group chat I am in:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

What we will do when someone breaks a norm:

EXIT TICKET

One sentence I could say or send if I saw a group chat start to pile on someone:

[] I would like to talk to my teacher or counselor privately.

LEVEL-UP CHALLENGE (OPTIONAL)

Write a five-norm agreement for a friend group and what happens when a norm is broken. Pitch it in 30 seconds.

REFLECTION

1. The first moment in the case file where Amir could have changed things: _____
2. One small kind move I could make in a chat: _____
3. Who is on my Help Ladder for this? _____

Lesson 10: Built to Keep You Scrolling

CF-10: THE STREAK

ELI IS TWELVE. HE has a "streak" with a friend that counts how many days in a row they exchange a message. Eli's phone buzzes with reminders: "Do not lose your streak!" Eli feels pressure to open the app before bed. His feed never ends and the next video plays automatically. One night he realizes it is very late and he is tired, and he feels he cannot stop. He wonders if something is wrong with him.

Nothing is wrong with Eli. Features in the app were designed to make stopping hard.

WORKSHEET 10A: DESIGN DETECTIVE

Use the ScrollSpot mock screens. Circle each feature on the screens and fill in the table.

FEATURE	WHERE I FOUND IT	WHAT IT WANTS ME TO DO	ONE WAY I COULD TAKE BACK CONTROL
Endless scroll			
Autoplay			
Streaks			
Notifications and badges			
Like counts and comparison			
Variable rewards (you never know what comes next)			

WORKSHEET 10B: MY LIMITS PLAN

Choose two changes and one replacement habit. You can change your mind any time.

- ☐ Turn off one kind of notification: _____
- ☐ Choose a bedtime for my device: _____
- ☐ Set a time limit for one app: _____
- ☐ Move one app off my first screen: _____
- ☐ Other: _____

My replacement habit (what I will do instead): _____

One person who could help me stick to it: _____ (role is fine)

WORKSHEET 10C: MY HELP LADDER (FINAL)

Finish the card you started in Lesson 1.

MY HELP LADDER

Rung 1: Me	One thing I do first: _____
Rung 2: A friend who could come with me	_____
Rung 3: Trusted adults (at least two)	1. _____ 2. _____
Rung 3: A trusted adult at school	_____
Rung 4: A way to report	The platform's report tool; school counselor; NCMEC CyberTipline: report.cybertip.org , 1-800-843-5678 [VERIFIED 2026-10-05: report.cybertip.org]
My drill (if someone threatens or pressures me)	STOP, SAVE, TELL, REPORT. Do not pay. It is not my fault.
For crisis support	Call or text 988; text HOME to 741741 [VERIFIED 2026-10-05: 988lifeline.org ; crisistextline.org]. In danger: 911.
My next-rung rule	If the first person does not help, I tell the next one.

Keep it in a safe place, like a notebook or a backpack pocket.

EXIT TICKET

One limit I chose: _____ One person I could ask for help sticking to it: _____

[] I would like to talk to my teacher or counselor privately.

LEVEL-UP CHALLENGE (OPTIONAL)

Try one limit for seven days. Each night, note how your sleep and mood felt. This is private. Tell a trusted adult if something is bothering you.

REFLECTION

1. Which design feature pulls on me most? _____
2. One thing I will try this week: _____
3. Who is on my Help Ladder if screen time or an app makes me feel worse? _____

Plus Lessons (P1 to P3)

YOUR TEACHER MAY GIVE you these extra lessons. They work like the other lessons: a made-up case file, a few worksheets, an exit ticket. Everyone is fictional. You can use your Pass card at any time.

Lesson P1 (Plus): Work, Pressure and Promises Online

REMEMBER: YOU CAN USE your Pass card at any time. This is a fictional file. We talk about a character, not about anyone here. It is never your fault, and it is never too late to tell.

CF-PI: THE OFFER

Dani is thirteen. After posting a short video, Dani gets a message from an account that calls itself a "talent scout": "You could make real money. No experience needed. Don't tell anyone yet, in case someone steals your spot. I'll cover everything. We just need to chat on a different app." Dani feels flattered and a little uneasy. The scout's profile has almost no posts. Dani closes the app and wonders what to do.

THE SIX FLAGS

- **SECRET:** "Don't tell anyone."
- **TOO GOOD:** big rewards for very little effort.
- **MOVE:** a push to another app, or to meet in person, alone.
- **OWE:** gifts or favors that turn into a debt.
- **CUT OFF:** someone pulls you away from family or friends.
- **TAKES:** someone wants to hold your money, phone, documents or accounts.

Ask three questions: who is this, what do they want, and who else knows?

WORKSHEET P1A: OFFER CHECK

Use your group's six Offer Cards. Circle the flags you see. Mark each card GREEN (looks fine; still check with an adult), YELLOW (check first) or RED (stop and tell).

CARD	FLAGS I SAW	G / Y / R	WHO I WOULD CHECK WITH
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			

Which card was fine, and what made it fine?

WORKSHEET PIB: SAY IT FOR A FRIEND

You are Dani's friend. Nobody plays the scout. Finish the Tell-3 sentences:

- 1. Start: "I need your help with something online."
- 2. One sentence: "A friend of mine was offered _____ by someone they do not know, and was told _____."
- 3. Ask: "Can you help me figure out what to do?"

The listener says: "Thank you for telling me. You are not in trouble. Let's work it out together."

CONTROL SIGNS (FOR NOTICING, FOR YOURSELF OR A FRIEND)

Someone else holds money, phone or ID. Someone says not to talk to family or friends. A debt keeps growing. Someone seems afraid to say no, or afraid to say where they go. If you notice these, you do not have to work it out alone.

QUICK CARD

Reporting Quick Card (cut out)

FIELD NOTE

No. 3

IF AN OFFER OR SOMEONE'S CONTROL WORRIES YOU

Tell a trusted adult first: a parent or caregiver, a teacher, the school counselor.

A trusted adult can call: Florida Human Trafficking Hotline 1-855-FLA-SAFE (1-855-352-7233) [VERIFIED 2026-10-05: fdle.state.fl.us] or Florida Abuse Hotline 1-800-962-2873 [VERIFIED 2026-10-05: myflfamilies.com]. Anyone can make a report.

National Human Trafficking Hotline: 1-888-373-7888, 24 hours [VERIFIED 2026-10-05: humantraffickinghotline.org/en/contact].

In danger now: 911. Crisis support: call or text 988 [VERIFIED 2026-10-05: 988lifeline.org].

It is never your fault. It is never too late to tell.

ALTERNATE ACTIVITY: CF-PI-ALT "REMY'S JOB OFFER" (JOB SCAMS)

Remy is thirteen and wants to earn money. A message says: "Paid data-entry job, \$40 an hour, no experience. Pay a \$60 starter fee by gift card today to hold your spot. Do not tell anyone, the spot will go to someone else." Remy feels excited and a little uneasy.

1. Circle the flags: _____ Mark it GREEN, YELLOW or RED: _____ Why? _____
2. One question Remy could ask to check the offer:

3. Say the Tell-3 for a friend: "A friend of mine was offered a job that asks for a fee and was told not to tell anyone."

EXIT TICKET

One flag from today: _____ One adult or helper I could tell:

[] I would like to talk to my teacher or counselor privately.

LEVEL-UP CHALLENGE (OPTIONAL)

With counselor approval, write a three-line Offer Check card for a younger cousin, using the flags and no scenario detail.

REFLECTION

1. Why might someone ignore the uneasy feeling, and why is that not their fault? _____
2. What would I say to a friend who tells me about an offer like this?

3. Who is on my Help Ladder for this? _____

Lesson P2 (Plus): Scroll Science

REMEMBER: YOU CAN USE your Pass card at any time. We talk about characters and "some people." You never have to share your own screen time or feelings. It is never your fault, and you do not have to do it alone.

CF-P2: PIA'S NIGHT

Pia is twelve. Most nights Pia scrolls in bed "for a few minutes." Last night it was two hours. Pia is tired in the morning and snapped at a friend. Looking at other kids' posts makes Pia feel like everyone else has a better life. A group chat went quiet after Pia posted something, and Pia keeps checking the phone, even in class, to see if anyone answered. Pia wants to stop checking and cannot seem to. Pia does not know what to do.

Pia is not lazy or weak. Many apps are built to be hard to put down.

WORDS TO KNOW

- **Social comparison:** looking at other people's posts and measuring yourself against them. Spending a lot of time on it can make some people feel worse about themselves.
- **Push notification:** an alert an app sends to tell you about something on your account, like a like, a comment or a message. Notifications are one design feature that can make it harder to stop checking.
- **Addiction:** a word some people use when something feels impossible to stop even though it is causing problems with sleep, school or friends. A doctor or counselor decides whether someone has a health problem. A quiz or a friend cannot.
- **Reward and the brain:** your brain uses chemical messengers. One of them, dopamine, helps you notice and want things that feel rewarding, like a laugh, a win or a message from a friend. Apps are built so that likes, comments and alerts can feel rewarding at unpredictable times, which can make it easier to keep checking. Scientists are still learning how strong this is for different people, and you still get to choose.

WORKSHEET P2A: SOLID, STILL STUDIED, OR HYPE?

Place each Evidence Card. Write one reason.

CARD	SOLID / STILL STUDIED / HYPE	MY REASON
1 Apps use alerts, streaks and endless scroll on purpose		
2 Late-night screens can cut into sleep		

CARD	SOLID / STILL STUDIED / HYPE	MY REASON
3 Polished posts can make some people feel worse		
4 "Social media causes depression"		
5 "Every like is a dopamine hit, like a drug"		
6 Only a doctor or counselor can say if use is a health problem		

WORKSHEET P2B: SIGNALS

SIGNAL CARD	TRY A RESET / TALK TO SOMEONE / GET HELP TODAY	ONE NEXT STEP	ONE HELPER
(a) stays up late, tired at school			
(b) wants to cut down and cannot			
(c) stopped doing things once loved			
(d) says they feel hopeless or want to hurt themselves			

The last card always means: tell an adult today. Nobody waits on that one.

WORKSHEET P2C: MY RESET

Circle two:

- ☐ Device sleeps outside my bedroom at night
- ☐ Turn off one kind of notification: _____
- ☐ One hour with the app off
- ☐ Call or message a friend instead
- ☐ A walk or something offline I enjoy
- ☐ Unfollow an account that leaves me feeling worse
- ☐ Set a timer: _____

One person who could help me stick to it: _____ (role is fine)

Add to my Help Ladder card: a trusted adult at school
 _____ and, if my school has one, the school resource
 officer _____. Crisis support: call or text 988. In danger:
 911.

EXIT TICKET

One reset I chose: _____ One person who could help me stick to it: _____

[] I would like to talk to my teacher or counselor privately.

LEVEL-UP CHALLENGE (OPTIONAL)

Try one reset for seven days. Each night, note how your sleep and mood felt. This is private. Tell a trusted adult if something is bothering you.

REFLECTION

1. Which signal would I notice first? _____
2. What could a friend say that helps without judging?

3. Who is on my Help Ladder if screen time or an app makes me feel worse? _____

Lesson P3 (Plus): Fact, Fiction or Fake?

CF-P3: THE CLOSING RUMOR

TAVI IS TWELVE. A post says, "SCHOOL CLOSED TOMORROW because of a danger. Tell everyone!" It has a scary photo. Friends are forwarding it. Tavi's heart is pounding and Tavi's thumb hovers over "share."

THE CHECK STRIP

- **WHO** made it? Is the account real?
- **PROOF:** what shows it is true? Fact or opinion? Was a source named?
- **WHO ELSE** says so? A school, a trusted news source, an official? Where did the numbers come from, and when?
- **FEELING:** is it trying to scare, anger or rush me?
- When it fits: **LOOK CLOSER** at a picture or video (when, who, edited?) and check the **DATA** in a chart (who is it about, when, who collected it, one source or several?).

WORKSHEET P3A: CLAIM CHECK

CLAIM CARD	FIRST QUESTION I WOULD ASK	GOOD EVIDENCE WOULD BE	SHARE / CHECK FIRST / DO NOT SHARE / TELL AN ADULT
1 School-closing rumor			
2 "Miracle cure"			
3 "Private message" screenshot			
4 Confident chatbot answer			
5 Reading-score chart			
6 "Today's" flood photo			

WORKSHEET P3B: MY SHARE PAUSE RULE

"If I cannot say who made it and who else says so, I do not pass it on."

My own version: _____

If a post is hurting someone, scaring people, or asking for money or personal information: use the report button in the app, and tell an adult.

EXIT TICKET

One question from the Check Strip I will ask before sharing:

_____ One person I could check with:

REFLECTION

1. When did a post make me want to share fast? What was the feeling? (No names, no details.) _____
2. What could I say privately to a friend who shared something false?

3. Who could I tell if a rumor were hurting someone?

Case Closed: Unit Reflection

YOU HAVE FINISHED THE Case Files. Answer honestly. No one will grade your feelings.

1. The most useful skill I practiced:

2. The case file that stayed with me most, and why:

3. Check what you can now do:
 - ☐ Say Pause · Check · Tell and explain each step.
 - ☐ Say the Tell-3 script out loud to an adult.
 - ☐ Use FLAGS to check a message.
 - ☐ Name the four stages of an unsafe pattern.
 - ☐ Say STOP, SAVE, TELL, REPORT in order and explain why we do not pay.
 - ☐ Name the Upstander Four.
 - ☐ Choose one limit for my own screen use.
 - ☐ (Plus lessons, if you did them) Name three flags in a risky offer; tell what is solid and what is hype about feeds and mood; use the Check Strip before sharing.
4. Who I will tell if something online goes wrong: _____
(role is fine)
5. One sentence I want to remember: It is never my fault, and it is never too late to tell.

My Help Ladder card is finished: [] Yes [] Not yet

